

From: Cian Mac Liatháin D00274413@student.dkit.ie
Subject: University of Galway Complaint OMB-152443-V2W8R5Fwd: Query
re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174
Date: 27 Jun 2025 at 09:23:08
To: Ombudsman Complaints OMB complaints@ombudsman.ie
Cc: Michal Molcho michal.molcho@universityofgalway.ie, Cornelia
Connolly cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie, Maeve McCaldin
maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie, maire.niriordain@ucc.ie,
Kathy O'Sullivan kathy.osullivan@universityofgalway.ie

Hi Barry Quirke etal.

You requested further evidence of me having tried my best to
follow the appeals process of the University of Galway

Appeals process incorrectly followed, Natalie Walsh incorrectly
refused me entry to the MGO and the Professor in charge of the
appeals sarcastically emphasised mental health challenges
completely irrelevant to the illogicality of the decline of entry
into MGO programme.

CCed are those relevant to this complaint.

See attached evidence, Professor Becky Whay's last email to
me stating she refuses to appeal, and refuses to accept
complaint about the mishandling of my application.

Why is the Ombudsman so ambivalent when presented with
instances of ableist exucational abuse?

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>
Date: 26 June 2025 at 17:23:14 IST
To: Becky Whay <becky.whay@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: Maeve McCaldin

<maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>, Cornelia Connolly
<cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie>,
caitrona.nicdhonncha@gretb.ie,
moirin.nicfhlanncadha@gretb.ie, Dean of Students
<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>

**Subject: Re: Query re Application to the University of
Galway Ref:0100798174**

You are stating that I am not allowed do the MGO because
Coláiste na Coiribe won't allow me to teach Computer Science
or Maths?

Having a BME is not a balid reason to deny someone entry to
the MGO. Yes they will. I fully qualify and I will require in writing
why exactly I cannot choose Matamaitic/Gaeilge/
Ríomheolaíocht for the MGO this September before I proceed
with a complaint to the Dean of Students.

On 26 Jun 2025, at 17:10, Whay, Becky
<becky.whay@universityofgalway.ie> wrote:

You don't often get email from becky.whay@universityofgalway.ie. [Learn why this is important](#)

Caution: This is an external email and may be malicious.
Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments.

Dear Cian,

Thank you for your e-mail and I am very sorry to hear of your
mental health challenges and the impact that this has on you.

In regard to you not receiving an offer for the Máistreacht Ghairmiúil san Oideachas (MGO), I have been in contact with the school and examined the decision-making process that they undertook. I deem their process to be fair and transparent and concur with the reasons they give for not making you an offer to study on this programme.

As a result, I cannot uphold your appeal.

On the basis that I believe the application review process the school undertook and which Natalie Walsh communicated to you was appropriate, fair and transparent, I do not consider that there are grounds to pursue a complaint against her.

Mise le meas,

Professor Becky Whay

Professor Becky Whay

An tUachtarán Ionaid agus Meabhránaí | Deputy President and Registrar

Oifig an Uachtaráin Ionaid agus Meabhránaí | Office of the Deputy President and Registrar
T : +353 (0)91 492121



OLLSCOIL NA GAILLIMHE
UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY

University
ofGalway.ie

University of Galway is a registered charity RCN 20002107

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: 25 June 2025 17:43

To: Deputy President and Registrar <dpr@universityofgalway.ie>

Subject: Complaint against Natalie Walsh Fwd: Please help. Fwd: Following your email to me recently Fwd: These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

You don't often get email from d00274413@student.dkit.ie.
[Learn why this is important](#)

Professor Whay,

I know you don't know me. My application for the College of Arts -> School of Education course the Máistreacht Ghairmiúil san Oideachas was declined by Natalie Walsh due to me having an English teaching qualification and, according to her, the subject Ríomheolaíocht not being available on the course.

The fact that I am already a qualified teacher in English is a good thing showing my preparation to complete the MGO in Irish, and Ríomheolaíocht IS a module available on the course.

Neither of her responses are relevant reasons to dismiss an application, and the latter reason is completely UNTRUE and insults the intelligence of the course directors and other peers of mine of the School of Education.

I have a severe mental health disability that hinders my ability to feel valuable or ask for help - Complex Post Traumatic Stress Disorder.

I am having difficulty following Natalie's link, can you accept this email as my complaint against her ableism and invalid rejection from a course I am fully qualified for and would be an asset to - a conclusion drawn based on my past lecturers' feedback to me in the School of Education

Mise le meas,
Cian Mac Liatháin
11476078

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <cian.lyons@icloud.com>
Date: 25 June 2025 at 16:57:55 IST
To: Admissions Arts <artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie>
Cc: D00274413@student.dkit.ie, Cornelia Connolly
<cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie>, Seán Ó Grádaigh
<sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie>, Maeve McCaldin
<maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>,
maire.niriordain@ucc.ie, Kathy O'Sullivan
<kathy.osullivan@universityofgalway.ie>, Dean of Students
<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>, Michal Molcho
<michal.molcho@universityofgalway.ie>, President University of
Galway <president@universityofgalway.ie>, Admissions Arts
<artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie>
Subject: Re: Please help. Fwd: Following your email to me
recently Fwd: These aren't valid reasons to decline my
application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the
University of Galway Ref:0100798174

You don't often get email from cian.lyons@icloud.com. [Learn why this is important](#)

Caution: This is an external email and may be malicious.
Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments.

Natalie the reason you dismissed my application was false,

Computer Science is an available module on the MGO.

So therefore offer me the place I qualify for?

My official complaint has been submitted to you via email as advised in your rejection to me. Why am I now forced to repeat myself, it's retraumatising?

On 25 Jun 2025, at 15:26, Arts Admissions
<artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie> wrote:

Dear Cian

Thank you for reaching out to us. I am very sorry to hear that you are unhappy with the decision regarding your application to the MGO.

We understand the importance of this matter to you and wish to advise that we have a formal appeals process as part of the Admissions Procedures [HERE](#), which you can follow. This process is outlined under the section titled '*Complaints and Appeals*'.

Please send your formal appeal to the Deputy President and Registrar, Professor Becky Whay.

Email: dpr@universityofgalway.ie.

If you have any further questions, please do let me know.

Kindest regards,

Natalie

Comhordaitheoir Iontrála Iarchéime | Postgraduate Admissions Coordinator

Coláiste na nDán, na nEolaíochtaí Sóisialta & an Léinn Cheiltigh
College of Arts, Social Sciences & Celtic Studies



OLLSCOIL NA GAILLIMHE
UNIVERSITY OF GALWAY

University
ofGalway.ie

Uimhir Carthanachta Cláraithe/Registered Charity Number 20002107

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Sent: 25 June 2025 09:51

To: artsadmissions@ollscoilnagaillimhe.ie <artsadmissions@ollscoilnagaillimhe.ie>

Cc: Connolly, Cornelia <cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie>; Ó Grádaigh, Seán <sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie>; McCaldin, Maeve <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>; maire.niriordain@ucc.ie <maire.niriordain@ucc.ie>; O'Sullivan, Kathy <kathy.osullivan@nuigalway.ie>

Subject: Please help. Fwd: Following your email to me recently Fwd:
These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts.
Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

Hi Natalie,

I got this contact from the NUIG switchboard. I know you don't know me, but please read the below forwarded email from bottom up and see my application the ellianrecruitment website.

I am the most qualified and best option to attend/improve/wnjoy the MGO this year.

For further clarification on what I mean, please also feel free to contact those CCes in the below emails regarding my academic stature here since 2011, and how my Disability effects me (James McCormack, Maeve McCaldin)

I deserve to be given a place on the MGO this year after what I've been through since graduating the BME in 2021.

If the place requires changes to my application e.g. teaching Maths and Irish instead of computer science etc, then I will do so. Graduating the BME most CERTAINLY does not preclude me from the MGO, it informs the allocation and leaves my merits within its context.

Mise le meas,

Cian

11476078

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Date: 24 June 2025 at 13:53:58 IST

To: President University of Galway
<president@universityofgalway.ie>,
peter.mchugh@ollscoilnagaillimhe.ie

Cc: Dean of Students

<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>, Maeve McCaldin
<maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>,
maire.niriordain@ucc.ie,

cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie,

sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie

Subject: Following your email to me recently Fwd: These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

I was advised by your office that my application would be treated fairly based on my merits.

My application has been dismissed for invalid reasons. I can teach maths/applied maths/coding/comp science BECAUSE I'm already fully qualified.

This MGO is part of my therapeutic recovery from the trauma caused to me by NUIG Security false reports against me damaging my reputation.

I will be offered a place on the MGO, as I have earnt.

I was given a sarcastic dismissal, based on random technicalities that aren't even important to the application or my ability to perform on the course, and given NO accommodations for this disabled student.

I command a meeting with Applications Admin and Maeve McCaldin if I don't get offered a place, or my solicitor will be in touch.

Mise le meas,

Cian

Sent from my iPhone

Begin forwarded message:

From: Cian Mac Liatháin <D00274413@student.dkit.ie>

Date: 24 June 2025 at 13:31:55 IST

To: applicationenquiry@universityofgalway.ie,
admissions@universityofgalway.ie

Cc: cornelia.connolly@universityofgalway.ie, Maeve McCaldin <maeve.mccaldin@universityofgalway.ie>,
President University of Galway

<president@universityofgalway.ie>,
sean.ogradaigh@universityofgalway.ie, Dean of Students

<deanofstudents@universityofgalway.ie>,
maire.niriordain@ucc.ie,

michal.molcho@universityofgalway.ie

Subject: These aren't valid reasons to decline my application, College of Arts. Re: Query re Application to the University of Galway Ref:0100798174

Excuse me,

This is not a valid reason to refuse me entry into the MGO.

Coláiste na Coiribe is a VEC school. I am retraining to qualify as Gaeilge.

I qualify for the course, why did you dismiss my qualification?

That was not warranted, it was traumatising. I will gladly teach Maths then, but you do not speak for the School of Education.

I most certainly should be offered a place.

I am the most qualified graduate of the BME. I can change whatever subject I choose to study in September.

You will be offering me a place now, then, no?

Regardless of what you state the main purpose of the MGO is, what I spend my money on academically and how and where I study is my prerogative. I am fully Garda vetted, I am welcome at this University and at the School of Education and at Coláiste na Coiribe

your sudden decline of my postgraduate course request after paying €100 should be reviewed.

Would you not agree?

Mise Lemass,

Cian Mac Liatháin (Uí dhéisigh)

Cian Lyons Deacy

11476078

4416038

Apple Inc Award winner in the Apple Hall of Fame who will improve the Apple Distinguished School Status of UoG and CnaC

Sent from my iPhone

On 24 Jun 2025, at 13:03, DO NOT REPLY - application enquiry <applicationenquiry@universityofgalway.ie> wrote:

Dear Cian

Thank you for taking the time to apply to the MGO programme.

We truly appreciate the effort you put into your application.

Please be advised that because you have successfully completed the Bachelor of Arts in Math's & Education, you have been awarded a teaching qualification, and so you are already a qualified teacher at post primary level in Ireland. The main benefit of completing the MGO is to qualify as a second level teacher, a qualification you already have.

Please also note that in reference to your personal

statement letter expressing your interest in teaching Coding at junior cycle and Computer Science at senior cycle. Neither of these two subjects are available on the MGO programme.

For the above reasons, your application must be declined. If you have any questions please do reach out to artsadmissions@universityofgalway.ie.

Kind regards

Natalie

Postgraduate Admissions Coordinator